MIL-C-11255A
31 JANUARY 1952
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-11255(Ord)
2 July 1951
MIL-C-1389
16 September 1949
Army 50-21-48
15 September 1949

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGES, PERCUSSION AND ELECTRIC PRIMED, 20-MM, FOR GUNS, M3, M24, AND M24A1

This specification was approved by the Departments of the Army, the Navy, and the Air Force for the use of procurement services of the respective Departments.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers percussion and electric primed cartridges for 20-mm guns used primarily from aircraft against the armored parts of other aircraft and may be used against lightly armored ground and sea-borne targets and personnel. The specification covers one type of the following cartridges, as specified (see 6.1):

Cartridge, Armor Piercing-Tracer, M95.
Cartridge, Incendiary, M96.
Cartridge, High Explosive-Incendiary, M97.
Cartridge, Target Practice, M99.
Cartridge, Armor Piercing-Incendiary, T21E1 (M330).
Cartridge, Electric, Armor Piercing-Tracer, M95.
Cartridge, Electric, Incendiary, M96.
Cartridge, Electric, High Explosive-Incendiary, M97.
Cartridge, Electric, Target Practice, M99.
Cartridge, Electric, Armor Piercing-Incendiary, T21E1 (M330).

1.2 Classification.—Cartridges shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1):

Grade A
Grade B

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, DRAWINGS, AND PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings, and publications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

JAN-A-625 —Ammunition, Small Arms, General Specification for.
MIL-P-528 —Powder, Propellent, for Small Arms Ammunition, 20-mm.
MIL-P-1394 —Primer, Electric, M52A, Loading, Assembling and Packing.

U. S. ARMY

57-136 —Steel, Sheet and Strip, Carbon and Alloy.
50-46-2 —Case, Cartridge, Brass, M21A1, for 20-mm, Hispano Gun/A/.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking of Shipments.

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DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS

Cartridges

75–1–177 —Cartridge, AP–T, M95, for 20-mm Guns, Assembly and Marking Diagram.

75–1–178 —Cartridge, Incendiary, M96, for 20-mm Guns, Assembly, and Marking Diagram.

75–1–179 —Cartridge, HEI, M97, w/Fuze, PD, M75, for 20-mm Guns, Assembly and Marking Diagram.

75–1–181 —Cartridge, TP, M99, for 20-mm Guns, Assembly and Marking Diagram.

75–1–283 —Cartridge, Electric, for 20-mm Gun, M24, Assembly and Marking Diagram.

75–1–294 —Cartridge, API, T21E1 (M330), 20-mm Guns, Assembly and Marking Diagram.

Arms and equipment

D7238478 —Gun, Automatic, 20-mm, M3.

D7238479 —Gun, Automatic, 20-mm, M24.

D7238322 —Gun, Automatic, 20-mm, M24A1.

D7692121 —Action, Test, Caliber .60 and 20-mm Assembly, List of Parts and Drawings.

D7553247 —Action, Test, Electric, Caliber .60 and 20-mm, Assembly, List of Parts and Drawings.

D7553258 —Barrel, Test, 20-mm (Case M21A1 or M21A1B1).

D7553261 —Gage, Pressure, 20-mm (Case M21A1 or M21A1B1) Assembly.

D7553269 —Rifle, Accuracy and Velocity, 20-mm.

C78589 —Tool, Obturating Cup, Seating and Knockout Assembly.

A7584596 —Obturator.

D7843674 —Classification of Cartridge Case Defects.

A39430 —Piston, Regular.

C78160 —Gages, Piston Hole Assembly.

B135729 —Gage, Piston Seat (Maximum and Minimum).

A39436 — Cylinder, Pressure, Small Arms.

49–6–46 —Rest, Recoil, Caliber .60 and 20-mm.

49–6–48 —Rest, Recoil, Multiple Purpose, Caliber .60- and 20-mm.

FB–22278 —Gage, Airspace, Small Arms Ammunition.

FD–14708 —Jig for Drilling Cal. .50, .60- and 20-mm Cartridges, Assembly and Details.

FD–16042 —Primer Firing Device, Electric, for Ammunition Testing.

D44021 —Target, Incendiary.

Packing

D7553202 —Packing and Marking for Cartridges, 20-mm, in Bulk, in Cans, M20, in Box, M22.

D7553210 —Packing and Marking for Cartridges 20-mm, in Bulk, in Cans, M21, in Box, M23.

D7553235 —Packing and Marking for Cartridges, 20-mm, Linked, in Cans M21, in Box, M23.

F7553334 —Packing and Marking for Cartridges, 20-mm, in Bulk, in Cans, M21, in Box, Ammunition, Mk 1, Mod 0.

F7553332 —Packing and Marking for Cartridges, 20-mm, Linked, in Cans, M21, in Box, Ammunition, Mk 1, Mod 0.

PUBLICATIONS

ORDNANCE CORPS

ORD M608–PM-Vol. III—Manual of Test Methods for Small Arms Ammunition.

ORD–SIP–S315–Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition.

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ORD–SIP–S324 — Standard Inspection Procedure for Packing Small Arms Ammunition.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design and construction.

3.1.1 *General.*—General requirements shall conform to Specification JAN–A–625.

3.1.2 *Material.*—Material shall conform to Specification JAN–A–625, applicable specifications, and drawings.

3.1.3 *Processing.* — The contractor shall maintain a system of processing which will insure that the process average quality with respect to all requirements is equal to or better than the acceptance quality levels specified herein. Where electric primed cases are concerned, each primed case shall be tested for electrical resistance prior to assembly into cartridges.

3.1.4 *Electrical resistance of primed cartridge case.* — The electrical resistance of each primed cartridge case, measured with a circuit approved by the inspector, shall be not less than 500 nor more than 1,200,000 ohms.

3.1.5 *Physical requirements.*—The physical requirements of cartridges shall conform to applicable specifications and drawings, and the defects shall not exceed that specified in table I. The acceptable quality levels with respect to visual, dimension, and weight defects shall be in accordance with level II, table III of Standard MIL–STD–105, and as follows:

Defects	Grade A	Grade B
Critical	0	0
Major	1.00	1.50
Minor	2.00	3.00

TABLE I.—*Visual, gaging, and weighing defect classification.*

No.	Defect	Critical	Major	Minor	Major or minor
	Visual				
	Cartridge				
1	Discolored, dirty, oily, smeared (waterproofing)			x	
2	Corroded		x		
	Mixed ammunition types	x			
	Gap between cartridge case and rotating band 1/32" or more at any point			x	
	Marking misleading or unidentifiable			x	
	Case				
	Wax coating missing		x		
3	Round head		x		
4	Dent				x
5	Split case[1]		x		
6	Perforated case[1]		x		
7	Draw scratch				x
8	Scratch			x	

[1] A split or a perforation in the (s) or (j) position shall be counted as a major defect when no loss of powder occurs; and as a critical defect when loss of powder occurs. A split or a perforation in the (k), (l), or (m) position shall be counted as a critical defect. See table III for positions.

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TABLE I.—*Visual, gaging, and weighing defect classification.*—Continued

No.	Defect	Critical	Major	Minor	Major or minor
9	Beveled underside of head		x		
10	Case not crimped to projectile	x			
	Incomplete or improperly located crimp			x	x
11	Scaly metal				
12	No chamfer on head (rim)		x		
13	Fold			x	
14	Wrinkle			x	
15	Buckle			x	
16	Bulge			x	
17	Defective head			x	
18	Defective mouth			x	
	Projectile				
	Crack or split in shot, M95, or in shell body (M96 or M97)	x			
	Crack or split in nose, fuze, windshield or adaptor		x		
	Loose projectile component or components		x		
	Nose or fuze not staked (M96, M97 or M99)			x	
	Gap between nose or fuze and projectile 0.020 inch or greater			x	
21	Scratch			x	
	Cuts or imbedded foreign material on rotating band			x	
26	Upset (crooked) or deformed point (nose, fuze, windshield or adaptor)			x	
	Paint damaged (incomplete coverage)			x	
	Primer				
29	No primer	x			
30	Cocked primer	x			
31	Inverted primer	x			
32	Loose primer		x		
33	Nicked or dented primer			x	
34	No waterproofing (primer pocket joint)			x	
35	Defective crimp			x	
	Lacquer on primer button (electric primer)		x		
	GAGING				
	Cartridge				
	Long overall length[2]			x	
	Short overall length			x	
	Cartridge profile failure (requiring more than 80 pounds dead weight to insert in profile and alinement gage)[3]		x		

[2] When overall length is greater than 7.25 inches on M95, M96, M97, or T21E1 (M330) cartridges, the defect shall be classified as a critical defect; and when the overall length is greater than 7.25 inches on M99 cartridges, the defect shall be classed as a major defect.

[3] Each failing cartridge shall be linked with nine cartridges containing no defects. A gun, 20mm, M3, of minimum breeching space, conforming to Drawing D7238478 for percussion primed cartridges or a gun, 20mm, M24, of minimum breeching space, conforming to Drawing D7238479, for electric primed cartridges, shall be loaded with the linked cartridges in such manner that the failing cartridge will be the initial one chambered. When test cartridge fails to chamber completely it shall be counted as a critical defect.

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TABLE I.—*Visual, gaging, and weighing defect classification.*—Continued

No.	Defect	Critical	Major	Minor	Major or Minor
	Visual				
	Case				
	Large extractor groove diameter		x		
	Small extractor groove diameter			x	
	Large diameter head			x	
	Small diameter head		x		
	Thick head		x		
	Thin head		x		
	Long head to shoulder			x	
	Short head to shoulder		x		
	Primer				
	High primer		x		
	Low primer			x	
	Weight				
	Cartridge weighing less than minimum shown on cartridge drawing[4]			x	

[4] Each lightweight cartridge shall be broken down and the powder weighed. Each such cartridge found to contain less than 250 grains of powder shall be counted as a critical defect.

Note.—For photographs of visual defects Nos. 1–35 refer to Publication ORD–SI P–S315.

3.1.6 *Workmanship.*—Workmanship shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625.

3.2 Cartridge case. — The cartridge case shall not split when tested as specified in 4.2.

3.3 Projectile extraction. — The average force required to separate the projectile from the case shall be 1,400 ± 200 pounds, inclusive, and the standard deviation in the readings shall be less than 230 pounds.

3.4 Velocity.—The basic velocity of the projectile at 78 feet from the gun muzzle when fired automatic and the standard deviation shall be as shown in table II.

3.5 Waterproof.—The average velocity of cartridges after submergence in water as specified in 4.5 shall not vary from the average velocity of the same lot by more than 100 feet per second.

TABLE II.—*Basic Velocity and Standard Deviation.*

Cartridge	Basic velocity ± 50 f.p.s.	Standard deviation
Armor Piercing-Tracer, M95	2,680	40
Electric, Armor Piercing-Tracer, M95	2,680	40
Incendiary, M96	2,740	40
Electric, Incendiary, M96	2,740	40
High Explosive-Incendiary, M97	2,700	40
Electric, High Explosive-Incendiary, M97	2,700	40
Target Practice, M99	2,710	40
Electric, Target Practice, M99	2,710	40
Armor Piercing, Incendiary, T21E1(M330)	2,810	40
Electric, Armor Piercing-Incendiary, T21E1(M330)	2,810	40

3.6 Pressure.—The average pressure as determined by test in 4.6 and standard deviation shall not exceed that specified by the Government inspector.

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3.7 Accuracy.—The average of the mean radii of all targets obtained at 600 yards as determined by test in 4.7 shall not exceed that specified by the Government inspector.

3.8 Trace (applicable only to M95 percussion and electric primed cartridges).—Of the shots fired in the trace test, not less than 90 percent shall trace at least 2.0 seconds.

3.9 Incendiary flash (applicable only to M96 and T21E1 (M330) percussion and electric primed cartridges).—The score of the incendiary flashes obtained at 175 yards shall be not less than 80, when fired against incendiary target conforming to Drawing D44021.

3.10 Shell function (applicable only to M97 percussion and electric primed cartridges).—Ninety percent of the M97 shell fired, as in 4.10, shall detonate with high order within the area bounded by the front target plate and a plane normal to the line of fire and 18 inches to the rear of the back target plate.

3.11 Function and casualty.—The cartridges shall function the service weapon properly. Function and casualty firing defects plus all other firing defects shall not exceed the limits specified in table III.

3.12 Hangfire.—The hangfire time of the group of cartridges when fired as specified in 4.12 shall not exceed 0.002 second. Cartridges fired in the hangfire test comprise part of the function and casualty test.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling procedures and inspection.

4.1.1 *Sampling.*

4.1.1.1 *Ammunition lot.*—Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, an ammunition lot shall consist of the number of cartridges produced in one day at the particular plant or unit concerned. However, where a day's production is relatively small, an ammunition lot may include the production of two or more consecutive days but not more than 2,000,000 cartridges. The number of cartridges in a probational lot shall not exceed 500,000.

TABLE III.—*Firing defects and limits permitted in a lot.*

Defects	Limits, percent	
	Grade A	Grade B
Misfire	0	0.1
Projectile remaining in bore	0	0
Premature burst[1]	0	0
Premature ignition[2]	0	0.1
Primer leak:		
a. Perforation in firing pin indent in primer cup	0.5	0.5
b. Escape of gas through (or around) primer cup other than a.	2.5	2.5
c. Loose primer[3]	0	0.2
d. Blown primer[4]	0	0
e. Button missing from primer	0	0.2
Case casualty:		
a. Longitudinal split[5]		
(1) neck and shoulder (i and s)	2.5	2.5
(2) body (j)	0.5	0.5
(3) body (k)	0	0
(4) to head (l)	0	0
(5) through head (m)	0	0
b. Circumferential rupture[5]		
(1) partial; neck, shoulder or body (i, s, j or k)	0.4	0.4
(2) partial, head (l)	0	0
(3) complete	0	0
Failure to extract, including sheared rim	0	0
Failure to chamber	0	0.5
Gun stoppage (from ammunition defects not listed above)	0	0.1
Separation of metal parts of projectile in flight	0.5	1.0

Note.—The number of defects permitted shall be calculated as provided in Specification JAN–A–625.

[1] Premature burst is defined as functioning of an M97 shell or a T21E1 (M330) in the gun or in flight before impact.

[2] Premature ignition is defined as functioning of an M96 shell in the gun or in flight before impact.

[3] Primer falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt after firing.

[4] Primer not in pocket after firing and both head of cartridge case and pocket enlarged and distorted (determined visually).

[5] For location indicated by small letters in parenthesis, see drawing B7643674.

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4.1.1.2 *Inspection lot.* — The contractor shall submit a lot for visual inspection, gaging and weighing by inspection lots. Sampling of such inspection lots with respect to visual inspection, gaging, and weighing shall be in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.1.1.3 *Size of acceptance sample.* — The size of acceptance sample for inspection shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625.

4.1.1.4 *Size of test sample.*—The size of sample for the various tests shall be as specified in table IV.

TABLE IV.—*Test samples—first test.*

Test	No. of cartridges
Cartridge case	30
Projectile extraction	20
Velocity firing	20
Waterproofing firing	20
Pressure firing	20
Accuracy	50
Trace	100
Incendiary flash	20
Shell function	020
Function and casualty, and hangfire	200

4.1.2 *Inspection and tests, general.*

4.1.2.1 *Place.*—After the cartridges, either in inspection lots or in lots, have been inspected visually, gaged, and weighed by the contractor for the defects shown in table I, the visual inspection, gaging, weighing, and tests for acceptance shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625; and, unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, they shall be made at the place of manufacture.

4.1.2.2 *Firing defects.* — In any ballistic test except function and casualty in which a misfire occurs, a projectile remains in a bore, or a projectile bursts before reaching the target, an additional cartridge shall be fired. That particular test shall not be penalized but the ammunition sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with table III.

4.1.2.3 *Defective weapons.* — When any firing defect is found to have been caused by the small arm used, such firing defect shall not be counted against the ammunition but the small arm shall be corrected or replaced and the test repeated. This applies also in any retest of ammunition.

4.1.2.4 *Retests.*—Retests shall be made in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625.

4.1.3 *Inspection.*—Each cartridge of the inspection sample shall be inspected, gaged, and weighed in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625 for all defects specified in table I. Examination shall be made to assure proper packaging, packing, and marking in accordance with Publication ORD–SIP–S324. Cartridges containing such defects shall be eliminated from the inspection sample.

4.2 **Cartridge case test.**—Each cartridge case of the test sample shall be given a mercury cracking test in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625, except that time of submersion shall be 30 minutes.

4.3 **Projectile extraction test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be tested in a tensile test machine of suitable capacity which will register accurately the force required to extract the projectile from the cartridge case when rate of travel of the test head is controlled within 0.125 to 0.25 inch per minute, inclusive. The extractive force required to separate the projectile from each cartridge shall be reported together with the average force and standard deviation in the individual readings.

4.4 **Velocity firing test.**—Cartridges of the test sample shall be fired fully automatic for velocity at a cyclic rate of not less than 650 rounds per minute in gun, 20mm, M3, con-

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forming to Drawing 51–131–1, for percussion primed cartridges or in gun, 20mm, M24, conforming to Drawing D7238478, for electric primed cartridges, whichever is appropriate. The method of test shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625 and subsection 7–13 of Publication ORD–M608–PM, volume III. The velocities and rates of fire shall be recorded.

4.5 **Waterproof firing test.**—Cartridges of the test sample shall be fired fully automatic in the weapons and at the cyclic rate specified in 4.4. The method of test shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625 and subsection 7–13 of Publication ORD–M608–PM. Velocities and rates of fire shall be recorded.

4.6 **Pressure firing test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be fired single shot for pressure in gage, pressure, 20mm (case M21A1 or M21A1B1), conforming to Drawing D7553261, assembled to action, test, caliber .60 and 20mm, conforming to Drawing D7692121, for percussion primed cartridges or assembled to action, test, electric caliber .60 and 20mm, conforming to Drawing D7553247, for electric primed cartridges, whichever is appropriate, mounted in rest, recoil, multiple purpose caliber .60 and 20mm, conforming to Drawing 49–6–48. The method of test shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625 and subsections 7-11 and 7-13 of Publication ORD–M608–PM.

4.7 **Accuracy firing test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be fired for accuracy in weapon conforming to Drawing D7553269, held in rest conforming to Drawing 49–6–46. The method of test shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625 and subsection 7–14 of Publication ORD–M608–PM.

4.8 **Trace firing test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be fired for trace, single shot, in gun, 20-mm, M3, conforming to Drawing D7238478, for percussion primed cartridges or in gun, 20-mm, M24, conforming to Drawing D7238479, for electric primed cartridges, whichever is appropriate. The method of test shall be in accordance with subsection 7–18 of Publication ORD–M608–PM. Elevation of the weapon and length of range shall be such that complete burning of the tracer element occurs prior to impact of the projectile. Time of trace shall be measured with a suitable timing device.

4.9 **Incendiary flash firing test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be fired for incendiary flash in weapon conforming to Drawing D7553269, mounted in rest, recoil, multiple purpose, caliber .60 and 20-mm, conforming to Drawing 49–6–48. The method of test and scoring shall be in accordance with subsection 7–19 of Publication ORD–M608–PM.

4.10 **Shell functioning test.**—Each cartridge of the test sample shall be fired for shell functioning in weapon conforming to Drawing D7553269 mounted in rest, recoil, multiple purpose, caliber .60 and 20-mm, conforming to Drawing 49–6–48. Impact shall be against two mild steel (FS1010 hot rolled, annealed and pickled, or cold rolled dead soft temper) targets 3 feet apart. The front target shall be U. S. Standard 30 gage and the rear target U. S. Standard 14 gage. Targets shall be approximately 12 inches square and in accordance with Specification 57–136. Both targets shall be placed normal to the line of fire with the face of the front target 300 feet from the muzzle of the gun. The point of functioning and the character of detonation shall be observed and recorded.

4.11 **Function and casualty test.**—Cartridges of the test sample shall be fired for function and casualty, fully automatic, at a cyclic rate not less than 650 rounds per minute in bursts of 50 rounds, in gun, 20-mm, M3, conforming to Drawing D7238478 for percussion primed cartridges or in gun, 20-mm, M24, conforming Drawing D7238479 and in gun, 20-mm, M24A1, conforming to Drawing D7238322 for electric primed cartridges, whichever is appropriate, as follows:

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Ammunition	Weapon	No. of rounds
Percussion primed	Gun, 20-mm, M3	200
Electric primed	Gun, 20-mm, M24 or Gun, 20-mm, M24A1	200

The method of test shall be in accordance with subsection 7–15 of Publication ORD–M608–PM.

4.12 **Hangfire test.**—Cartridges of the test sample shall be fired for hangfire in burst of 50 rounds, fully automatic, at a cyclic rate not less than 650 rounds per minute in gun, 20-mm, M3, conforming to Drawing D7238478 for percussion primed cartridges, or in gun, 20-mm, M24, conforming to Drawing D7238479 for electric primed cartridges, whichever is appropriate, using a machine gun chronograph. Where electric primers are involved, primer, firing device, electric, for ammunition testing, conforming to Drawing FD–16042 shall be used. The method of test shall be in accordance with subsection 7–16 of Publication ORD–M608–PM. Cartridges fired in the hangfire test shall be considered as part of the function and casualty test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Packaging.**—Cartridges shall be packaged in accordance with applicable drawings.

5.2 **Packing.**—Cartridges shall be packed in accordance with applicable drawings.

5.2.1 *Inspection of pack.*—Inspection of pack shall be in accordance with Publication ORD–SIP–S324.

5.2.2 *Acceptance of pack.*—Acceptance of pack shall be in accordance with Specification JAN–A–625.

5.3 **Marking.**—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 **Ordering data.** — Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Grade desired (see 1.2).
c. Place of inspection, if not at place of manufacture (see 4.1.2.1).
d. Whether domestic or overseas packing is required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Marking of shipping containers required (see 5.3).

6.2 **Test of components.**—When the contractor for the cartridge is also the contractor for one or more of the components thereof, the ballistic tests of the components may be combined with the ballistic tests of the cartridge to save expense, upon agreement between the Government inspector and the contractor.

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